



IIT Bhilai Innovation and Technology Foundation

IIT Bhilai, Transit Campus, Govt. Engineering College, Old Dhamatari Rd,
Sejbahar, Chhattisgarh (492015)

CIN: U80902CT2021NPL011186 | PAN: AAFCI9961E | TAN: JBPI01305D

Website: <https://www.ibitf.co.in/> | Email: tih@iitbhilai.ac.in

SBIF LEAP: Innovators for Bharat

Pan-India Incubation Programme for Start-ups

IIT Bhilai Innovation and Technology Foundation (IBITF), with funding support from SBI Foundation, invites applications from eligible start-ups and innovators developing technology-driven solutions in the areas of FinTech, AgriTech and HealthTech.

SBIF LEAP: Innovators for Bharat is a structured incubation programme aimed at supporting innovative, technology-driven solutions that address real-world and localized social challenges.

Objective

The objective of this Call for Proposals is to identify and support 12 technology-driven start-ups working in FinTech, AgriTech and HealthTech through a structured incubation programme at the Pan-India level. The programme aims to support innovations at Technology Readiness Level (TRL) 3 and above in progressing from proof-of-concept and prototype development towards validation, field deployment and scalable real-world applications.

The programme will provide selected start-ups with seed funding, technical expertise, incubation infrastructure, mentorship, training, policy guidance, industry linkages and ecosystem partnerships to strengthen their technology and business readiness. It will also encourage R&D advancement, IP/patent development, research collaboration and skill development, while facilitating partnerships with Government agencies, grassroots organizations and industry for testing, validation and scaling.

The programme particularly seeks to support inclusive, scalable and sustainable solutions addressing localized social needs and challenges, with potential to create measurable impact through secure and inclusive FinTech solutions, smarter agricultural practices and improved livelihoods, and AI-enabled healthcare solutions for underserved and rural communities.

Support and Opportunities

Selected start-ups and innovators may receive:

- Seed funding support of up to ₹8.5 lakh per project, subject to project requirements and applicable terms.
- Access to IIT Bhilai's technical expertise, innovation and incubation ecosystem.
- Support for prototype development, testing, validation and field deployment.
- Mentorship, training, policy guidance and technical support.



IIT Bhilai Innovation and Technology Foundation

IIT Bhilai, Transit Campus, Govt. Engineering College, Old Dhamatari Rd,
Sejbahar, Chhattisgarh (492015)

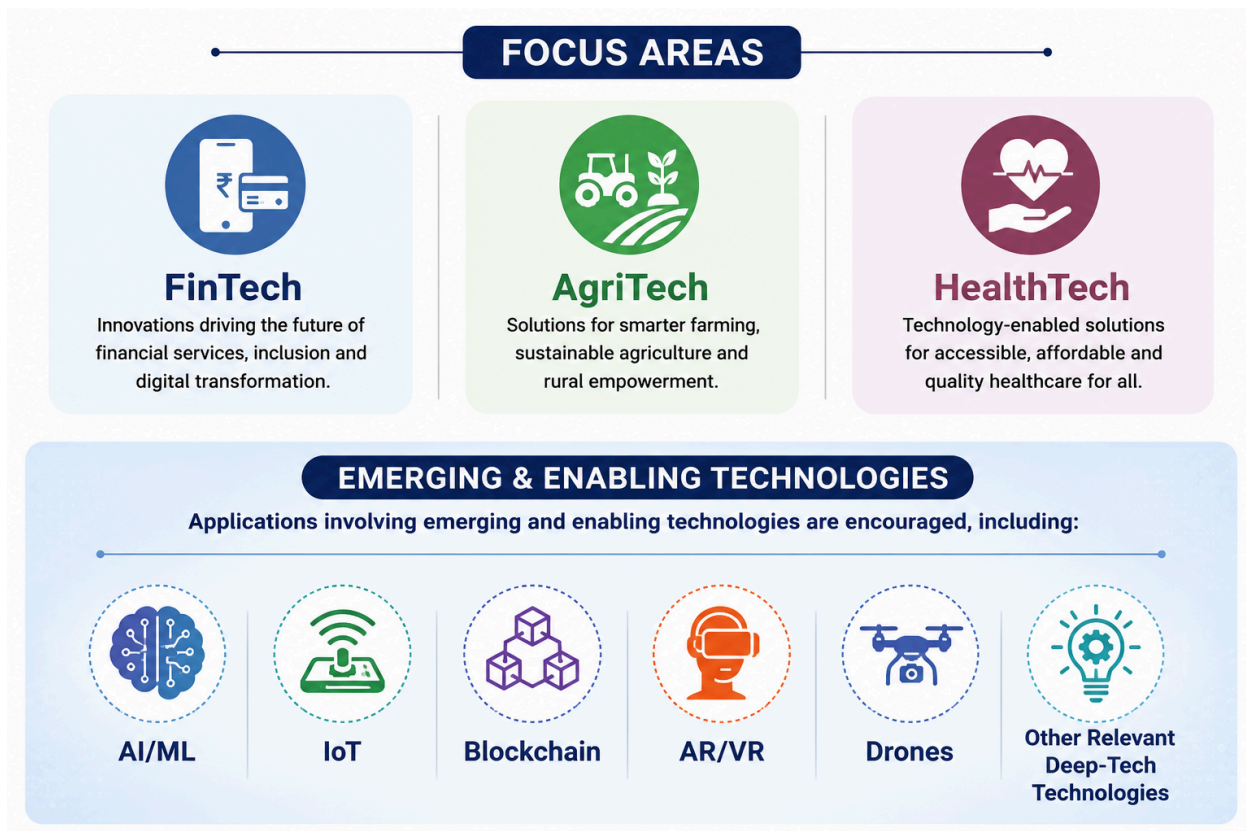
CIN: U80902CT2021NPL011186 | PAN: AAFCI9961E | TAN: JBPI01305D

Website: <https://www.ibitf.co.in/> | Email: tih@iitbhilai.ac.in

- Access to relevant prototype development facilities, smart labs, discussion rooms, laboratories and other incubation infrastructure, as applicable.
- Industry linkages, investor interactions and ecosystem networking opportunities.
- Facilitation of partnerships with Government agencies, grassroots organizations and industry partners for testing, validation and scaling of solutions.

Apply Under the Following Areas

The programme will primarily support technology-driven innovations across FinTech, AgriTech and HealthTech, with a strong emphasis on the application of emerging and enabling technologies such as Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning (AI/ML), Internet of Things (IoT), Blockchain, Augmented and Virtual Reality (AR/VR), Drone-based technologies, and other relevant Deep-Tech solutions that demonstrate potential for real-world application, scalability and social impact.





IIT Bhilai Innovation and Technology Foundation

IIT Bhilai, Transit Campus, Govt. Engineering College, Old Dhamatari Rd,
Sejbahar, Chhattisgarh (492015)

CIN: U80902CT2021NPL011186 | PAN: AAFCI9961E | TAN: JBPI01305D

Website: <https://www.ibitf.co.in/> | Email: tih@iitbhilai.ac.in

Local Needs & Social Impact

The programme seeks to support inclusive, scalable and sustainable technology-driven solutions addressing real-world and localized social challenges, with preference given to innovations that address specific problems and needs of Chhattisgarh and have the potential to directly benefit its communities. Priority will be given to solutions that can improve livelihoods, enhance access to essential services and opportunities, and create meaningful social impact for rural, tribal, underserved and economically weaker communities in the State. Solutions promoting affordability, accessibility, local partnerships, institutional collaboration and community-level capacity building will be encouraged, to enable their transition from prototype development and validation to real-world deployment and sustainable impact.

Programme-Level Expected Outcomes

The programme aims to build a pipeline of **technology-driven, scalable and socially relevant innovations** that can progress from prototype development to **real-world validation, deployment and adoption**.

Through funding, incubation support, technical expertise, mentorship and ecosystem partnerships, selected start-ups will be expected to contribute, as applicable to their projects, towards the following programme-level outcomes:

- Patents/IPs arising from supported innovations.
- Research publications based on R&D and technology development undertaken under the programme.
- Partnerships with Government bodies, grassroots organizations or relevant stakeholders for field testing, validation and scaling of solutions.
- Skill development of professionals through workshops, training and knowledge-sharing activities.
- Engagement of researchers and innovators in collaborative R&D and innovation activities.
- Development and deployment of sector-specific solutions using emerging technologies, including smart agricultural practices, secure FinTech solutions and AI-enabled healthcare solutions for underserved and rural communities.
- Facilitation of the transition of supported innovations from prototype development and validation towards real-world application, scalability and sustainable impact.



IIT Bhilai Innovation and Technology Foundation

IIT Bhilai, Transit Campus, Govt. Engineering College, Old Dhamatari Rd,
Sejbahar, Chhattisgarh (492015)

CIN: U80902CT2021NPL011186 | PAN: AAFCI9961E | TAN: JBPI01305D

Website: <https://www.ibitf.co.in/> | Email: tih@iitbhilai.ac.in

Eligibility & Preference

Eligible applicants should meet the following broad criteria:

- Innovations should have reached TRL 3 or above, including Proof of Concept, prototype development or validation in a relevant environment.
- Solutions should address real-world and localized social needs or challenges.
- Preference will be given to solutions demonstrating potential for prototype/pilot readiness within three months for real-world application.
- Preference will be given to start-ups from Tier-2, Tier-3, rural and underserved regions, particularly from Chhattisgarh and nearby areas.
- Women-led start-ups, youth innovators and student entrepreneurs are encouraged to apply.
- Preference will be given to solutions demonstrating potential for scalability, sustainability and direct or indirect employment generation.

Selection Process

The selection process will follow a structured evaluation pathway, beginning with Application & Eligibility Screening, followed by Technical and Commercial Evaluation. Shortlisted applicants will undergo Pitch Presentation/Interview, followed by Expert Review and Due Diligence. The final recommendations will be placed before the Project Management Committee for approval, followed by final selection and onboarding of the selected start-ups and innovators.

Application Process

Deadline for Proposal Submission: 31st August 2026

All proposals must be submitted via the **Link** : <https://tihiitbhilai.accubate.app/ext/form/24180/1/apply>

A copy of the submitted applications shall be emailed to tih@iitbhilai.ac.in

Contact

IIT Bhilai Innovation and Technology Foundation (IBITF)

Indian Institute of Technology Bhilai

Email: tih@iitbhilai.ac.in

Website: www.ibitf.co.in

Phone: +91 7587738819